

tration of sensitive data, with attacks specifically targeting pharmaceutical companies and institutions to harvest sensitive customer information for blackmailing and industry espionage. Companies in other sectors will be at risk of falling victim to targeted attacks via their VPN infrastructure and remote desktop applications they may be using to connect employees working from home.”

In fact, the expectation of cyberattacks on critical healthcare infrastructure is so widespread, that some of the known ransomware groups such as DoppelPaymer and Maze have themselves come forward and declared that they will not be attacking healthcare organisations.

Justine Bone, CEO at MedSec and an expert on the HP Security Advisory Board, also predicts an increase in attacks on healthcare companies going forward. “Healthcare has been a perfect target – society depends on it and these organizations are typically under-resourced, change-averse and slow to innovate. Education also fits this criterion and could be another prime target.” Robert Masse, Partner at Deloitte, and also on the HP Advisory Board adds, “due to the race to develop a new vaccine, pharmaceutical companies and research facilities will also continue to face adverse risk.”

Securelist by Kaspersky also predicts an increase in attacks on the pharmaceutical sector in 2021. One of the factors contributing to the attacks is that while the world is fighting the pandemic, the pharmaceutical companies are also racing against one another. Securelist also anticipates a series of patient data leaks in the coming months. Leaked patient information can subsequently be used as hooks in targeted attacks.

17 PREVENTIVE HEALTH CARE

Even as our January issue goes to print, states in India are organising mock drills for rolling out the vaccine. The storage and distribution of vaccines needs the setup of cold supply chains that can keep the vaccines in

suitable conditions. The reliance on contact tracing apps to track infections across public spaces such as malls and airports, as well as to inform and alert those who have faced exposure is only expected to increase as things get back to normal and more restrictions are lifted. Simple tests such as temperature checks will continue to be used to prevent potential spreaders into public places, and also by individuals to make a decision before stepping out. All of these behaviors show an increased focus on preventive measures, which is an old idea, but then hey the concept of social distancing is centuries old. To reduce the pressure on the system once a person is affected by COVID-19, there is tremendous pressure to implement technologies that prevent people from getting the disease in the first place.

care community to make sure that the purchase, distribution and storage of the vaccine can be carried out efficiently as per local market demands. Add to this many new trends such as Tele-Health, Electronic Medical Records, a focus on preventive healthcare and continued partnerships between the public and private sector can be seen gaining prominence in the healthcare research space. To understand these emerging trends across geographies, GLocalMind has conducted multiple market research studies including studying the Impact on healthcare practices, Impact on hospital operations, Adoption of tele-medicine, pricing perceptions for Covid Vaccine, healthcare innovation and transformation, etc.”

Apart from vaccines, there is a lot of focus on developing cheap,



The scratch n' smell test developed by Parker

Sandeep Sankhla, Founder & Managing Partner of a think tank called GlocalMind explains, “the COVID-19 outbreak has severely impacted the entire healthcare industry and changed the working structure of its ecosystem. With the pandemic being the biggest healthcare crisis ever faced by man in this generation, the medical community has been working feverishly across the world to identify a vaccine and to understand the short term and long term impact of this on the world. And now with news trickling in that there could be sufficient doses available for more than one-third of the world’s population by the end of 2021, countries are busy working closely with the health-

at-home tests that can conclusively inform an individual that they have contracted the disease. One of the exciting low-cost developments is a scratch and sniff at home test, which uses a person’s loss of smell as an indicator for the disease, as research shows that between 50-to-70 per cent of individuals with the disease are demonstrating a loss of the sense of smell, even without any other symptoms. Steven Munger, from the University of Florida is developing such a test, and explains its potential use. “Even though vaccines seem to be on the horizon and COVID testing is becoming more accessible in a variety of environments, there are still plenty of people who have a hard time

Credit: University of Colorado